

Stop losing money in your messy DMs! 🚨

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 28, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/rfeydgbefZc> Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, who has coached 15,000+ people on online fitness businesses, argues that top earners succeed not by growing their following but by building lead management systems — specifically using GoHighLevel to organize Instagram DMs.

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🏆 The Real Difference Between Top and Average Earners 0:00

- Most people believe growing their following is the key to making money online
 - Carter says this is wrong — the real differentiator is **systems**
- He has coached over **15,000 people** on building successful online fitness businesses
- His top students making **\$50,000–\$100,000/month** operate differently from those making only \$5,000–\$10,000/month
 - The gap is not audience size — it's how they manage leads

📊 The DM Problem: Why You're Losing Leads 0:21

- The common mistake: running your entire business through Instagram DMs with no system, no pipeline, and no strategy
- When a video goes viral or pops off, new messages flood your inbox
 - Leads you've already been nurturing get pushed down the feed
 - You forget about them and lose the sale
- Result: money is constantly slipping through the cracks without you realizing it

🛠️ The Fix: GoHighLevel + 5-Stage Pipeline 0:21

- Sync **GoHighLevel** to your Instagram account
 - Set up automations that sort incoming DMs into structured stages

- You can message leads directly from within GoHighLevel — no need to go back to Instagram
- Recommended 5-stage pipeline to set up from the start:
 - **New Lead** — someone who just entered your inbox
 - Warm Lead — a lead you've begun engaging with
 - Booked Call — lead has scheduled a call
 - Follow Up — lead needs further nurturing or re-engagement
 - Closed — deal is done
- This gives all your leads structure instead of sitting in a chaotic Instagram inbox

Scaling and Why You Should Start Now [1:05](#)

- As your business grows, you can add employees directly inside GoHighLevel
 - They can nurture leads and book calls on your behalf without ever touching your Instagram
- Even if you're just starting out, this system is essential
 - Small followings mean every single lead matters — you cannot afford to let any slip through

"If you got a small following, you need to make sure you maximize every lead you get."

- The takeaway: don't wait until you're bigger to build structure — the system pays off at every stage